

APPLICATIONS OF BIG DATA: SCIENCE

Demanding a shift in mindset, big data is posing a challenge for scientists, something that many in the global scientific community rise to meet with bravado.

This isn't the first time in history that scientists are faced with a plethora of data to find logical connections that lead to discoveries. In fact, one can easily make the argument that that's always been the case-after all scientists down the ages have been looking at the greatest data warehouse for inspiration-nature. But what differentiate the age of big data from the preceding ones is the availability of a multitude of data for a very large number of people in the scientific community.

Whereas earlier the finding of data itself would be a strenuous task warranting physical explorations that are demanding as well as time consuming, such data is readily available these days-at least to a large extent. The demanding part then comes with the finding of meaning from the data that's available.